

4 Lighting



Any photographer will tell you how important lighting is when taking a photograph. In the basic sense, photography is nothing more than capturing and recording light. Artists working in 3ds Max also use light, but because 3ds Max uses a digital representation of light, you can do things with light that are impossible in nature. In 3ds Max, you can switch a light's shadows on or off, vary the intensity of light according to distance, and create lights that actually remove light from a scene. 3ds Max also provides methods to create highly realistic and natural lighting, simulating the way real light propagates through an environment. These tools give you the freedom to create the real world or your own world.

4.1 Lighting adds up

Materials describe how an object reflects or transmits light, and define what the object will look like. A glass object will have a different material than a wooden one. Within a material, texture maps can be used to define the character of the surface, affecting parameters such as colour, opacity, bump mapping, and reflectivity, among many others.